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Quality Handoff Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe **measures, targets, security, compliance, resilience, observability, or important quality findings**.

This guide is about **how good is good enough, how it is measured, and what quality risks or obligations matter**.

KNOWLEDGE AREA

This guide helps with **quality expectations and measures**. Technically, it covers **quality attributes and measurable fitness**.

Guide family map

Where this guide sits in the full Blueprint Handoff Atlas family.

ROOT & CROSS-CUTTING

Handoff Atlas

Blueprint Bundle

Metamodel Vocabulary

Migrations

DESIGN

Architecture

Concepts

Domain

Dynamics

Infrastructure

Interactions

Models

Quality

Rules

Story

GOVERNANCE

Capability

Decisions

Motivation

Organization

Roadmap

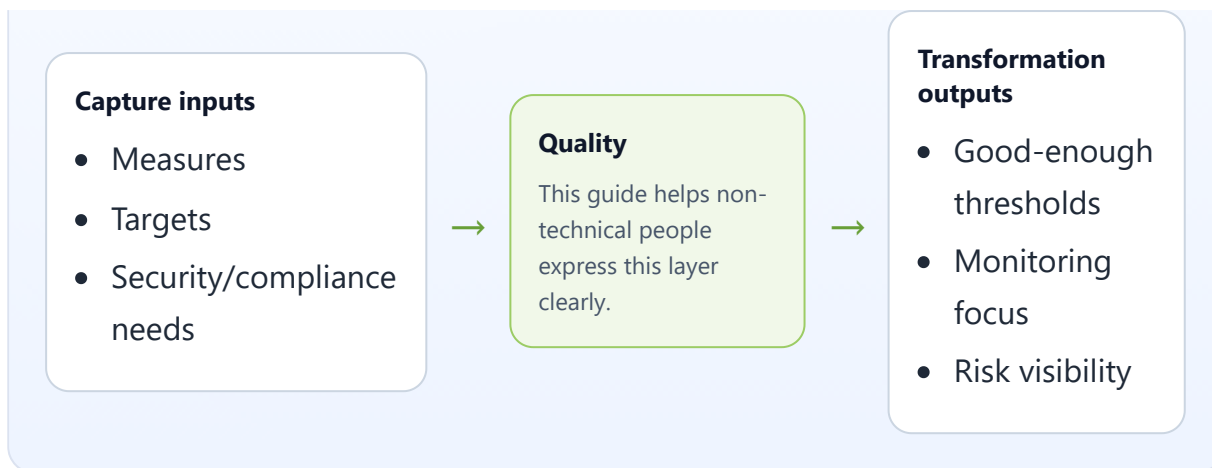
Leverage

Test Cases

Value Stream

Capture → focus → transformation

What to gather first, what this layer focuses on, and what a modeler or AI agent can produce from it.



Main entities in this guide

- **Metric** — a raw measurement of behavior, such as time, rate, or percentage.
- **KPI** — a business-facing target built on a metric.
- **SLO** — an internal service target the team commits to.
- **SLA** — an external promise with business consequences if it is missed.
- **Security Requirement** — a rule about protecting access, data, or auditability.
- **Compliance Requirement** — a legal, regulatory, or retention obligation.
- **Resilience Requirement** — an expectation about recovery, continuity, or failure handling.
- **Finding** — a current quality weakness or defect already observed in the system.
- **Observability** — the monitoring view made from metrics, logs, traces, and events.
 - Often confused with: **Leverage Point** in the Leverage guide. A **Finding** states what is wrong now; a leverage point states a prioritized intervention to improve it.

What belongs here

- metrics and KPIs
- service targets such as response time or uptime
- security requirements
- compliance and retention requirements
- resilience and recovery expectations
- observability expectations
- important quality findings or internal weaknesses

What does not belong here

- broad business goals without measurable or quality meaning
- the whole process flow
- static infrastructure inventory by itself

Core things to capture

- what should be measured
- what target or threshold matters
- what quality requirement must hold
- what risk or weakness already exists
- what evidence or monitoring should exist

Core relationships to capture

- goal -> KPI/metric
- operation/service -> SLO/SLA
- concept/data -> security or compliance rule
- system area -> resilience or observability need
- quality finding -> risk or remediation concern

Modus operandi

Capture quality by asking:

1. what matters to stakeholders?
2. how would we measure it?
3. what minimum acceptable target exists?
4. what obligations or protections apply?
5. what known weaknesses need visibility?

Prompt set

- what must be fast, accurate, secure, or reliable?
- how do we know whether it is good enough?
- what happens if it fails?
- what regulations or obligations apply?
- what quality problems already exist today?

Free-text intake template

- **Quality concern:**

- **Why it matters:**
- **What is measured or required:**
- **Target or threshold:**
- **Affected operations/concepts/services:**
- **Evidence/monitoring needed:**
- **Known findings or risks:**

Worked example

- Return eligibility decision should be visible to the customer within 30 seconds of submission
- Customer order data must be retained and accessed under privacy rules
- Audit logs must capture refund-decision changes

Layer-specific handoff guidance

For quality, the handoff should make **expectations testable**.

The receiver should be able to see:

- what quality concern matters
- how it is measured or observed
- what threshold or obligation exists
- what happens if it is not met

If the wording is only "important" or "better", the handoff is too vague.

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into metrics, KPIs, SLOs, security, compliance, resilience, observability, and findings entries.

Common mistakes

- saying something is important without a measurable meaning
- mixing business goals with operational targets
- forgetting security/compliance obligations
- omitting known quality weaknesses because they feel uncomfortable